

2.2 Unit B602: *Philosophy 2 (Good and Evil, Revelation, Science)*

Each of the faiths studied will be examined according to the issues specified below. Candidates should be able to explore the significance and impact of religions and support their answers with reference to the teachings, sacred texts, beliefs and attitudes of the faiths where appropriate.

In this unit candidates should reflect on the idea that religions have different approaches and attitudes and that there is diversity within each faith, its understanding of texts and its philosophy.

They should consider these issues in relation to the particular religion itself and to its impact on individuals, communities and societies, locally, nationally and globally whilst realising that these particular aspects may vary in significance between religions and communities.

They should also consider the extent to which the particular religion and belief being studied contributes to community cohesion.

Although the large variety of different philosophical and ethical views are not specified for each unit and whereas it would be too demanding for candidates to study a wide-range of different views at this level, nevertheless they should be aware that there is diversity of belief and opinion within each faith.

The final part of each question gives candidates the opportunity to express not only their personal views but also their understanding of other religions and beliefs including Humanism, Bahai, Jain and Zoroastrianism.

2.2.1 Buddhism

Good and evil

Good and evil

- Concepts of good and evil
- Skilful and unskilful actions
- The role of Mara

Buddhist beliefs about the causes of evil

- Concepts of natural and moral evil
- Approaches to why there is evil and suffering in the world
- Responses to the problem
- Kamma and rebirth

Coping with suffering

- Understanding ways of coping with suffering through:
 - Kamma
 - Meditation
 - Detachment
 - The three refuges

Sources and reasons for moral behaviour

- The scriptures
- The three refuges
- The example of Buddha
- The eightfold path

Religion, reason and revelation

Form and nature of revelation

- Concept of revelation
- Revelation of ultimate truths through Buddhas and bodhisattvas
- How nibbana might be known:
 - Scriptures
 - Meditation
 - Buddhas
 - Bodhisattvas

Authority and importance of sacred texts

- The origins of the Buddhist scriptures
- Significance and importance of the Buddhist scriptures

Religion and science

Origins of the world and life

- Scientific theories about the origins of the world and humanity
- Why Buddhists may not accept scientific theories
- The relationship between scientific and religious understandings of the origins of the world and humanity
- The cyclical nature of the universe
- The refusal to answer questions on causation
- The cycle of dependent origination

People and animals

- The place of humanity in relation to animals
- Attitudes to animals and their treatment

Environmental issues

- Responses to environmental issues
- Religious teachings relating to environmental issues